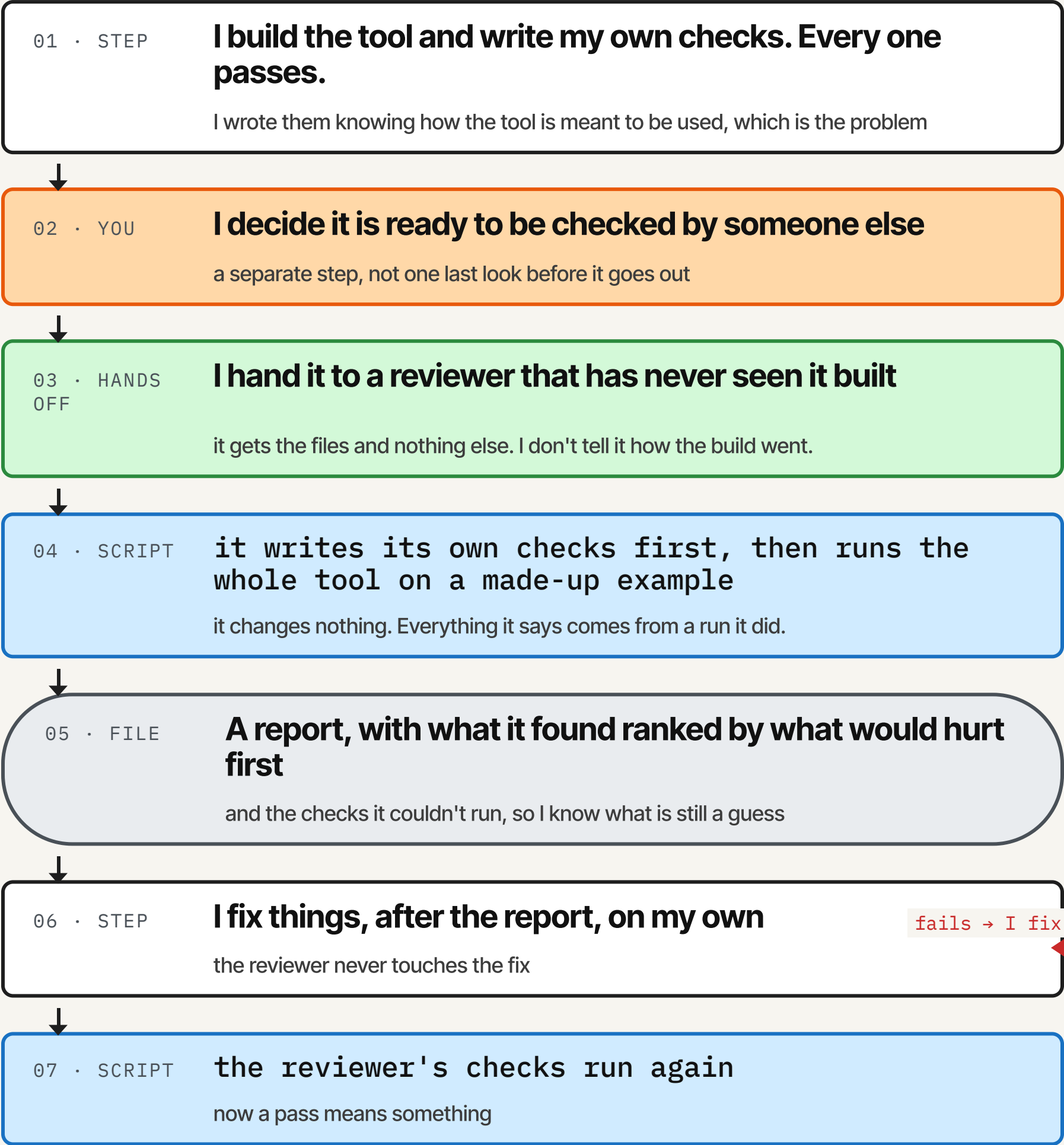


It passed its own tests. *Then it got checked.*

Every check I had said pass, so I shipped it. Then a separate reviewer that had never seen it built wrote its own checks, ran the whole thing on a made-up example, and found the bug mine couldn't. It had been quietly deleting part of my plan and telling me everything was fine.

How it runs, *top to bottom*.



The person who built it shouldn't be the one checking it.

Eight failures *my own checks couldn't see.*

The reviewer's first run, and the same checks today.

FIRST RUN, WRITTEN WITHOUT SEEING THE BUILD

THE REVIEWER'S FIRST RUN, WRITTEN WITHOUT SEEING THE BUILD

Forty checks it wrote itself. Thirty-two pass. Eight fail.

THE EIGHT THAT FAILED

- ✗ if the drawing of the plan is out of date, reading my edits off it quietly deletes parts of the plan
- ✗ two boxes with the same name get treated as one box even when they are different
- ✗ delete every step on the drawing and redraw it, and the tool crashes
- ✗ the tool doesn't notice when a question or a reason gets dropped from the plan
- ✗ a one-line text edit on the drawing is missed
- ✗ a plan written without numbered lines gets wrecked when the tool tries to

AFTER THE FIXES

THE SAME CHECKS TODAY, AFTER THE FIXES

Forty checks. Forty pass.

THE ONES THAT WOULD HAVE HURT MOST

- ✓ an out-of-date drawing can no longer delete parts of the plan, and a copy is saved first
 - ✓ two boxes with the same short name are no longer matched up by accident
 - ✓ the tool now notices when a question or a reason gets dropped
- forty checks, forty pass, none fail

A pass again. It means something now, because I didn't write the checks.

The worst one never crashed. It quietly deleted part of my plan, kept no copy, and said everything was fine.

What I tell it, *so you can copy it.*

Six lines. They work on anything you've built and want checked by something that didn't build it.

WHAT I TELL THE REVIEWER, SO YOU CAN COPY IT

How to get your work checked by something that didn't build it

- "Read only the files. You have no memory of how this was built.
- Write your checks before you see anything I said about how it should work.
- Run the whole thing start to finish on a made-up example.
- Rank what you find by what would hurt first, not by what is easiest to fix.
- Report, and never fix. I fix things after, on my own, then your checks run again.
- Say which checks you couldn't run, so I know what is still a guess."

The person who built it shouldn't be the one checking it.

A pass means more when someone else wrote the checks.